

ONE PLANNING PERIOD, AND AI IS SET UP FOR YOUR WHOLE YEAR

Back-to-School AI Setup Pack

Everything in this pack is doable in a single planning period during the first week: a setup checklist that takes about 45 minutes end to end, a ready-to-send family letter about how you'll use AI this year, and ten back-to-school prompts that are safe exactly as written. Fill the **[BRACKETS]**, review every draft like the professional you are, and nothing reaches a student or family unread.

BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE, THE RULE

Never put student personally identifiable information into a public AI tool.
Describe the need, not the child.

What's in this pack

- **The First-Week AI Setup Checklist** — ten boxes, one planning period, done for the year.
- **The family letter** — a ready-to-send note about how you'll use AI this year, written to build trust at open house, not raise eyebrows.
- **Ten back-to-school prompts** — welcome letters, icebreakers, routines, open house, and your first diagnostic, all safe by design.
- **The make-it-safe habit** — the three de-identification moves and the ten-second test, on one page for your desk.

The First-Week AI Setup Checklist

Work top to bottom. Times are honest; the whole list fits one planning period.

- ☐ **1 · Pick your one tool and bookmark it.** Whatever your district has approved; if nothing is approved yet, any major free chatbot works for adults-only planning. 3 min
- ☐ **2 · Test it on school Wi-Fi.** Log in from the device you'll actually plan on. Filters block things; find out now, not in October. 3 min
- ☐ **3 · Memorize the rule.** No student personally identifiable information in a public AI tool. Not a name, not a detail, ever. 1 min
- ☐ **4 · Do one safe rewrite.** Take a task you'd naturally phrase with a student in it, strip the identity, and run the safe version. Notice nothing was lost. 5 min
- ☐ **5 · Start a "prompts that worked" doc.** One running page. Every prompt that saves you 20 minutes goes in it, forever. 3 min
- ☐ **6 · Draft your welcome letter with prompt #1.** Then make it yours: your voice, your details, your read-through. 10 min
- ☐ **7 · Personalize the family AI letter.** It's the next page. Swap the brackets, print or paste it into your welcome packet. 8 min
- ☐ **8 · Put 10 minutes on your calendar, weekly.** Same day, same time: one new task tried with AI. Habits beat intentions. 2 min
- ☐ **9 · Find your district's AI policy status.** Approved tool? Draft guidance? Nothing yet? One sentence in your planner covers you. 5 min
- ☐ **10 · Pick one colleague to swap prompts with.** Two teachers comparing notes will out-learn any workshop. 2 min

The family letter: how I'll use AI this year

Ready to send as-is once the brackets are filled. Works printed in the welcome packet, pasted into your first newsletter, or read aloud at open house. It answers the three questions families actually have before they ask them.

Dear families,

Before the year gets busy, I want to share how I use new technology in my planning, because you deserve to hear it from me directly. This year I will sometimes use AI tools the way I use other planning tools: to draft a first version of things like newsletters, practice questions, and leveled reading passages, which I then rewrite and review myself.

Here is my commitment to you. I never put your child's name or any personal information into these tools, full stop. Every word that reaches your family or your student is read, edited, and approved by me first. And the parts of teaching that matter most — knowing your child, grading their work, and caring about their progress — are mine and stay mine.

If AI comes up at your dinner table this year, I'm always glad to talk about how we handle it in [GRADE/CLASS]. Questions are welcome at [SCHOOL EMAIL].

Looking forward to a great year together,

[TEACHER NAME]

[SCHOOL]

Ten back-to-school prompts, safe as written

First week with families

1 • The welcome letter

"You are a warm, experienced [GRADE] teacher writing your back-to-school welcome letter to families. Include who I am (I'll add specifics), what makes this year exciting, and how to reach me. Friendly and plain; under 250 words; no exclamation-point pileups."

2 • Open house talking points

"Give me a 5-minute open house talk outline for [GRADE/SUBJECT]: what we'll learn this year, how homework works, how families can help at home, and how to contact me. Format: four short sections I can glance at while speaking."

3 • First-week newsletter blurb

"Write a warm newsletter blurb for families about our first week in [GRADE/SUBJECT]: [TWO OR THREE THINGS THAT HAPPENED]. Under 120 words, one paragraph, end with one thing to ask your student about at dinner."

Setting up your room

4 • Icebreakers that aren't cringe

"Give me six first-day icebreakers for [GRADE] that a shy student could survive: two no-talking options, two partner options, two whole-class options. Each under 10 minutes with zero prep materials."

5 · Classroom routines, poster-ready

"Turn these classroom routines into short, positive, poster-ready wording for [GRADE]: [PASTE YOUR ROUTINES]. Each one under 8 words, starting with a verb, no 'don't' statements."

6 · Getting-to-know-you survey

"Create a 10-question getting-to-know-you survey for [GRADE]: interests, how they learn best, what a good teacher does, and one thing they want me to know. Mix multiple choice and short answer; keep it to one page."

7 · Supply and materials one-pager

"Format this supply list into a clean family-friendly one-pager with a needed-by date and a 'no worries if you can't' line: [PASTE LIST]. Group items by category."

First content**8 · Syllabus, student-friendly**

"Rewrite this syllabus section so a [GRADE] student actually reads it: [PASTE SECTION]. Same rules, half the words, friendly but firm, formatted as short bullets."

9 · Day-one diagnostic

"Create a 10-question beginning-of-year diagnostic for [GRADE/SUBJECT] covering [LAST YEAR'S KEY SKILLS]. Low-stress wording, mixed formats, answer key with what each miss suggests I reteach."

10 · Group-work ground rules

"Write group-work ground rules for [GRADE] as a T-chart: 'sounds like / looks like.' Positive wording, six rows, ready to project. Add three sentence starters for disagreeing respectfully."

The make-it-safe habit (ten seconds, forever)

Every school prompt you ever write passes through three moves:

- **1 · Strip identity.** No names, no initials, no one-of-a-kind details.
- **2 · Generalize.** "A 7th grader" · "several students" · "a parent."
- **3 · Describe the need, not the child.** The reading level, the behavior pattern, the format you want back.

The ten-second test: could anyone who knows your school tell who this is? If yes, it doesn't go in. Names go back into your own email or doc after the draft comes back — never into the tool.

Want the full staff version? Our complete PD sessions — word-for-word scripts, editable slide decks, and handouts for whole-staff training — are in the store.

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